

Declarer Sheet — Notrump

Bridge Habit Map

PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

Discipline

- ☐ Pause at least 10 seconds before playing from dummy
- ☐ Treat it as a play problem handed to you on paper
- ☐ Review the auction — what's bid, what's not
- ☐ Analyse the opening lead — length, honor, shortness?

Pre-play evaluation

- ☐ Count points for us and the defenders
- ☐ Count our winners and losers
- ☐ Use info from opps' bidding and passing
- ☐ Use info from the opening lead
- ☐ Work out likely suit splits and where opps' high cards sit

Design the play

- ☐ Tricks to create = contract – winners
- ☐ Tools: ruff in short hand, create shortage for a ruff, cross-ruff, finesse
- ☐ Look for loser-on-loser elimination, squeeze, or throw-in
- ☐ Confirm entries for the planned play
- ☐ Decide when and how to draw trumps

Playing it out

- ☐ Don't be afraid to draw trumps even on a misfit
- ☐ If cross-ruffing, set up side suits first

- ☐ Play safe / the percentages — allow for 4-1 or 3-0 splits when a finesse is on
- ☐ If drawing trumps, make sure you have no suit losers in the short-trump hand
- ☐ Find losers in the long hand — discard them on dummy's winners
- ☐ In NT, if they lead your hidden 5-card suit, still play the hand properly
- ☐ If the outcome is fixed, try to fool the opps and sneak a trick

PLAN — NOTRUMP

Count

- ☐ Count sure winners (off the top)
- ☐ Work out how many extra tricks needed

Source of extras

- ☐ Pick suit(s) to develop — Force, Length, or Position
- ☐ Prefer Force when you can afford to lose the lead

Hazards & control

- ☐ How many tricks can defenders cash when in?
- ☐ Identify the danger hand — who must you keep off lead?
- ☐ Plan hold-ups to sever defensive communication

Execution

- ☐ Plan entries between hands; unblock high cards
- ☐ Decide which suit to attack first
- ☐ Cash short-suit winners last if needed as entries